

School closure scenarios: what to weigh before deciding (v2)

Legion of Data Nerds · Budget brief · Fall 2026

District 65 needs to cut about 10% of its budget. We looked at class sizes, the options on the table, our staffing against the State's funding model, building costs and the closure scenarios.

v2 data, as of October 1, 2026.

- **Class counts:** the district's FY27 (fall 2026) K–5 section list, a spreadsheet (`k5_sections_fy27.xlsx`) received by email from District 65 on October 1, 2026: 188 sections by school, grade and program. It replaces our estimate of 190 classes.
- **Enrollment:** re-pulled from data.district65.net on October 1, 2026: 5,415 students (5,462 on September 23).
- **Updated with October 1 data:** the class-size section, the class-size chart and correlation, and the "sections today" column in the classroom appendix.
- **Still on the September 23 enrollment:** building costs per student, the closure scenarios and the State funding comparison. No school's enrollment changed by more than 3% (Lincoln: 350 to 340).

About this version. This is a text version of `d65_budget_choices_handout.pdf`. It adds three things, each marked **Added**:

1. The facility plan's capital needs, folded into the building-cost comparison (section 01)
2. Closing Dawes, as a single closure and in pairs (section 02)
3. A check of the handout's classroom counts against the District's March 2026 Facility Master Plan (appendix)

What should guide the plan

1. **Decide by outcomes, not dollars.** Orient decisions and accountability toward what students learn, and judge every cut by its effect on the classroom.
2. **Build a learning organization.** Use data to improve, and be willing to say when something didn't work and change course.
3. **Engaged families are an asset.** Community groups like ours are part of a healthy district. When parents check out, the system has already failed.

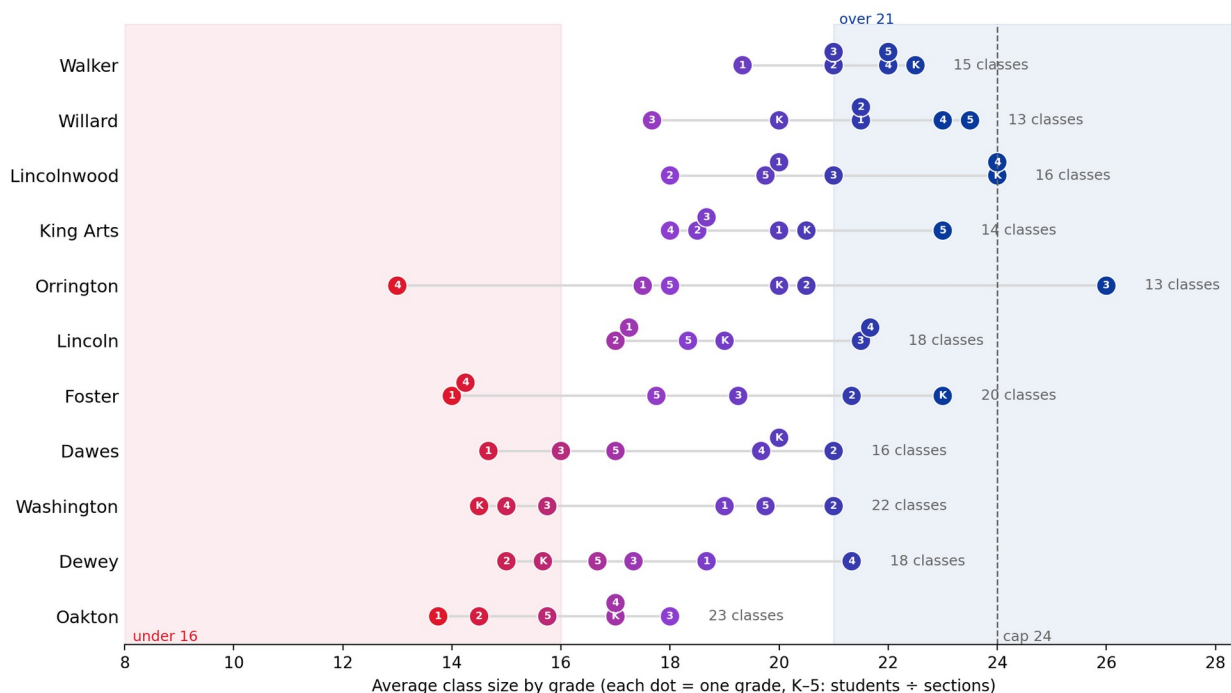
Risk assessment: a building-first plan

Risk	Level	What we found
Enrollment numbers are off	High	May projection: 604 kindergartners; fall actual: 534 (–12%). About 210 students attend by permissive transfer.
Receiving schools overfill	High	8 of 19 scenarios push a school past capacity (7 of 15 before Dawes was added).
Low-enrollment programs	High	Closing TWI, ACC or STEP buildings means moving whole programs.
One-time costs and special ed	High	Costs come before savings; IEP services must continue uninterrupted.
A two-tier system	High	Families who can afford it opt for private school, leaving D65 with fewer resources and less engaged support.
Transportation costs	Medium	\$150–270K a year per closure, 20–35% of building savings.
Equity	Medium	Closures land on specific

Risk	Level	What we found
		neighborhoods and TWI access.
Attention is finite	Medium	Closure planning takes time that staffing decisions need.

Class size and the student experience

A child's class size depends on their school and grade



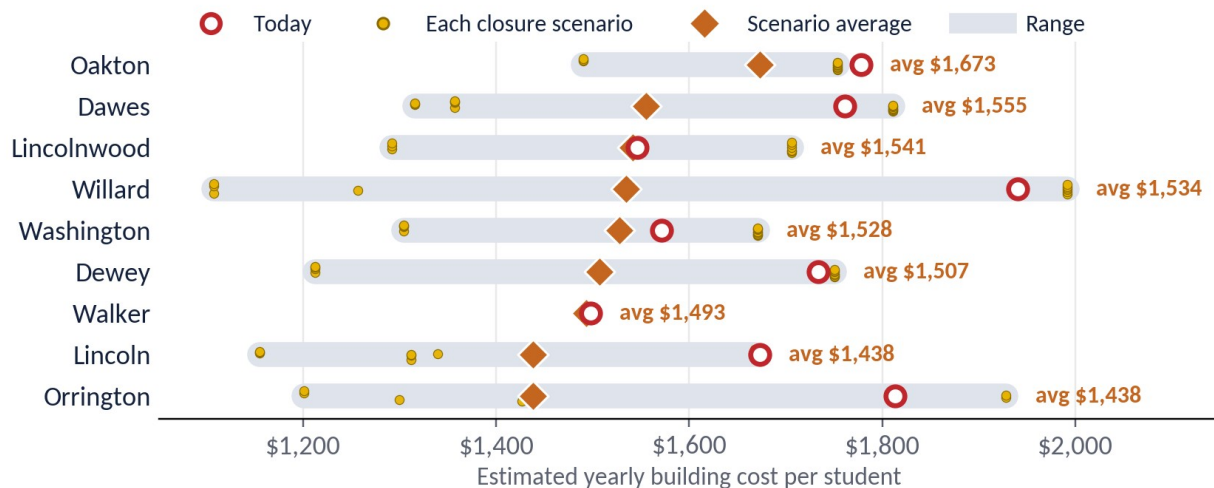
Sections: District 65 FY27 K-5 section list, received by email Oct 1, 2026. Students: data.district65.net, pulled Oct 1, 2026.

- **Grade averages run from 13 to 26 students per class.** Of the 66 K-5 school-grades, 12 average under 16 and 16 average over 21.
- **Same grade, different school.** A 3rd grader at Dawes or Washington is in a class of about 16; at Lincoln, about 21-22; at Orrington, 26. Orrington's 3rd grade has 52 students in 2 sections, above the 24 cap, which is worth confirming with the district.
- **Fuller buildings don't have bigger classes** ($r = -0.14$). The spread comes from how grades divide into classes and from TWI and ACC strands.

Each dot is one grade's average class size: students in the grade ÷ sections. The section list doesn't give students per class, so individual classes may be larger or smaller. Sections: District 65 FY27 K-5 section list, received by email October 1, 2026. Students: data.district65.net, pulled October 1, 2026.

01 • Building costs: which buildings cost the most to run?

Every building carries a principal, an office and custodians whatever its size, so emptier buildings cost more per student. At the average closure-scenario enrollment, Oakton, Dawes and Lincolnwood cost the most per student; Lincoln and Orrington the least.



Building	Students	Utilization now → avg*	Principal + office	Custodians	Utilities	Total a year	Per student now	Per student, scenario avg*
Oakton	367	79% → 84%	\$241K	\$345K	\$66K	\$652K	\$1,778	\$1,673
Dawes	288	67% → 75%	\$241K	\$209K	\$58K	\$507K	\$1,761	\$1,555
Lincolnwood	331	77% → 77%	\$241K	\$221K	\$50K	\$512K	\$1,546	\$1,541
Willard	273	51% → 65%	\$241K	\$227K	\$62K	\$530K	\$1,940	\$1,534
Washington	387	73% → 75%	\$241K	\$278K	\$90K	\$608K	\$1,571	\$1,528
Dewey	315	59% → 67%	\$241K	\$236K	\$70K	\$546K	\$1,734	\$1,507
Walker	317	73% → 74%	\$241K	\$186K	\$48K	\$475K	\$1,498	\$1,493
Lincoln	350	61% → 71%	\$241K	\$266K	\$79K	\$585K	\$1,673	\$1,438
Orrington	251	58% → 73%	\$241K	\$170K	\$45K	\$455K	\$1,813	\$1,438
King Arts	445	68%	\$241K	\$362K	\$101K	\$703K	\$1,580	—
Haven (MS)	604	65%	\$241K	\$514K	\$96K	\$850K	\$1,408	—
Chute (MS)	591	75%	\$241K	\$408K	\$102K	\$752K	\$1,272	—
Nichols (MS)	582	83%	\$241K	\$354K	\$83K	\$678K	\$1,164	—

What stands out

- **Receiving buildings get cheaper, but the district doesn't save that.** Adding students lowers cost per student only at the receiving buildings; the district saves just the closed building's costs.
- **Utilities are small.** They come to \$1.33M district-wide.

Data we still need:

- Maintenance and capital needs by building, likely larger than utilities (sources: 10-year Health/Life Safety survey, facility assessment). *Now added below from the Facility Master Plan.*
- Actual building staff by school
- Site-level spending per student (ISBE report card)
- Full-year 2026 utilities

*Scenario average = today's cost ÷ the building's average 2027–28 enrollment across the closure scenarios in section 02 where it stays open and at or under capacity (90% of displaced students stay). Foster has no utility account.

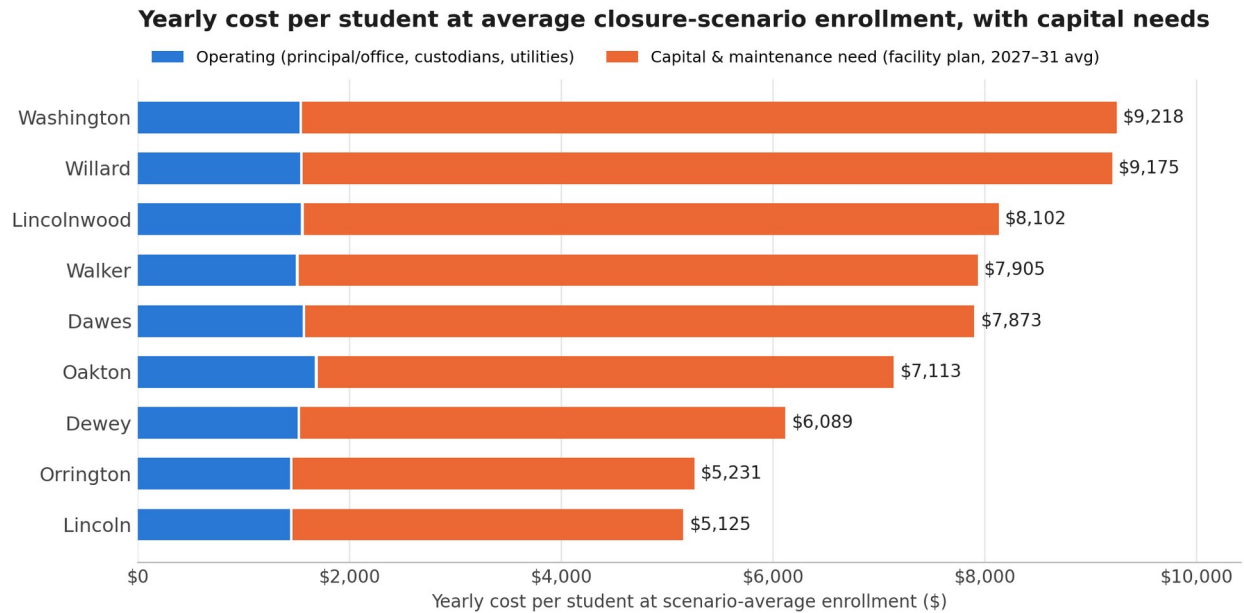
Sources and assumptions:

- Utilities and energy use: D65 dashboard (2025 data, pulled 9/23/2026). Square feet derived from energy use ÷ EUI.
- Enrollment: fall 2026 (D65 dashboard).
- Capacity: the smaller of the district's Cap Total and Cordogan Clark (2022).
- Principal pay: FY26 PA 96-0434 salary report (\$180,753 average).
- Custodians: 64, from the district's employee-category table, allocated by square feet.
- Assumed: custodian pay \$65K and office staff \$60K per building.

Built with help from Claude (AI); please verify.

Added: the same comparison with the facility plan's capital needs

The District's [Facility Master Plan](#) (Studio GC, March 2026 draft, pp. 22–23) estimates each building's capital and maintenance needs year by year. We took each building's 2027–31 total (the plan's first five years), spread it evenly over those five years, and added it to the operating costs above. Figures are per student per year at each building's **average enrollment across the closure scenarios**, sorted from most to least. The middle schools and King Arts are left out because they aren't part of the closure scenarios.



Capital = Facility Master Plan (Studio GC, Mar 2026 draft) 2027–31 need ÷ 5, escalated dollars. Operating = handout. Students = scenario-average 2027–28 enrollment.

Rank	Building	Students today	Scenario-average students*	Capital need, 2027–31 total	Capital need, full plan 2027–75	Operating per student	Capital per student (2027–31 avg)	Total per student
1	Washington	387	398	\$15.3M	\$43.3M	\$1,528	\$7,690	\$9,218
2	Willard	273	346	\$13.2M	\$25.7M	\$1,534	\$7,641	\$9,175
3	Lincolnwood	331	332	\$10.9M	\$31.6M	\$1,541	\$6,561	\$8,102
4	Walker	317	318	\$10.2M	\$29.1M	\$1,493	\$6,412	\$7,905
5	Dawes	288	326	\$10.3M	\$31.5M	\$1,555	\$6,318	\$7,873
6	Oakton	367	390	\$10.6M	\$36.6M	\$1,673	\$5,440	\$7,113
7	Dewey	315	362	\$8.3M	\$26.7M	\$1,507	\$4,582	\$6,089
8	Orrington	251	316	\$6.0M	\$25.2M	\$1,438	\$3,793	\$5,231
9	Lincoln	350	407	\$7.5M	\$34.0M	\$1,438	\$3,687	\$5,125

*Scenario-average students = the building's average 2027–28 enrollment across the closure scenarios in section 02 where it stays open and at or under capacity (90% of displaced students stay), the same basis as the handout's "per student, scenario avg" column. Operating per student is the handout's figure. Capital per student = 2027–31 total ÷ 5 ÷ scenario-average students. Capital totals are the facility plan's escalated figures (pp. 22–23).

What changes when capital needs are included

- **Capital dwarfs operating costs.** At scenario-average enrollment, capital needs run \$3,687–7,690 per student a year against \$1,438–1,673 in operating costs, 2.6–5 times as much. Across these nine buildings that's \$18.5M a year in capital against \$4.9M in operating costs.
- **The ranking shifts.**
 - **Most expensive:** Washington (9,175) per student, then Lincolnwood (\$8,102). Willard's cost per student falls from \$11,610 at today's enrollment because it gains the most students in the scenarios (273 → 346 on average).
 - **Least expensive:** Lincoln (5,231), then Dewey (\$6,089).
 - On operating costs alone, Oakton, Dawes and Lincolnwood were the costliest at scenario average. With capital needs, Oakton drops to 6th and Dawes to 5th.
- **Closure savings could be much larger, but only if the building leaves the district's books.** The handout's \$0.2–0.7M a year per closure counts operating costs only. A closed building that is sold, leased long-term or demolished also avoids its capital needs: \$1.2–3.1M a year for the K–5 schools in 2027–31, or \$6–15M over the five years. A building that is only mothballed still needs a roof, envelope, heat and life-safety upkeep, so most of that need stays.
- **Receiving schools' capital needs don't shrink.** The facility plan's needs are driven by building condition, not enrollment. Moving students into a building lowers its cost per student but not the dollars.
- **Treat these as planning estimates.**
 - The plan's figures are escalated at 4.5% a year.
 - The 2027–31 window leaves out the district-wide spike in 2034 (\$131.7M, when many systems come due at once), so longer-range averages run higher for most buildings.
 - The plan is a draft, and it doesn't separate must-do safety items from discretionary upgrades.

02 • Closure scenarios: what closures would do to the receiving schools

Each closed school's projected 2027–28 students go to its receiving schools, with 90% staying in D65. Pairs close one south school (Dewey, Washington, Oakton or **Dawes**) and one north school (Willard, Lincolnwood or Orrington). "Kept together" sends a school to one building; "split" divides it by open seats.

	Dawes	Dewey	Foster	Lincoln	Lincolnwood	Oakton	Orrington	Walker	Washington	Willard
No closures	65%	58%	58%	61%	69%	80%	55%	74%	69%	50%
1. Close Dewey split → 3 schools	65%	closed	76%	78%	69%	80%	74%	74%	69%	50%
2. Close Orrington kept together → 1 school	65%	58%	58%	61%	69%	80%	closed	74%	69%	90%
3a. Close Lincolnwood kept together → 1 school	65%	58%	58%	61%	closed	80%	117%!	74%	69%	50%
3b. Close Lincolnwood split → 2 schools	65%	58%	58%	61%	closed	80%	81%	74%	69%	79%
3c. Close Lincolnwood kept together → 1 school	65%	58%	58%	61%	closed	80%	55%	74%	69%	101%!
4. Close Oakton split → 3 schools	87%	84%	58%	61%	69%	closed	55%	74%	88%	50%
5. Close Dawes split → 3 schools	closed	80%	58%	61%	69%	90%	55%	74%	85%	50%
Dewey + Willard Dewey split 3 ways • Willard split 2 ways	65%	closed	76%	78%	92%	80%	107%!	74%	69%	closed
Dewey + Lincolnwood Dewey split 3 ways • Lincolnwood kept together	65%	closed	76%	78%	closed	80%	136%!	74%	69%	50%
Dewey + Orrington Dewey split 3 ways • Orrington kept together	65%	closed	74%	76%	69%	80%	closed	74%	69%	109%!
Washington + Willard Washington split 3 ways • Willard split 2 ways	89%	58%	58%	88%	92%	94%	88%	74%	closed	closed
Washington + Lincolnwood Washington split 3 ways • Lincolnwood kept together	89%	58%	58%	88%	closed	94%	117%!	74%	closed	50%
Washington + Orrington Washington split 3 ways • Orrington kept together	89%	58%	58%	88%	69%	94%	closed	74%	closed	90%
Oakton + Willard Oakton split 3 ways • Willard split 2 ways	87%	84%	58%	61%	92%	closed	88%	74%	88%	closed
Oakton + Lincolnwood Oakton split 3 ways • Lincolnwood kept together	87%	84%	58%	61%	closed	closed	117%!	74%	88%	50%
Oakton + Orrington Oakton split 3 ways • Orrington kept together	87%	84%	58%	61%	69%	closed	closed	74%	88%	90%
Dawes + Willard Dawes split 3 ways • Willard split 2 ways	closed	80%	58%	61%	92%	90%	88%	74%	85%	closed
Dawes + Lincolnwood Dawes split 3 ways • Lincolnwood kept together	closed	80%	58%	61%	closed	90%	117%!	74%	85%	50%
Dawes + Orrington Dawes split 3 ways • Orrington kept together	closed	80%	58%	61%	69%	90%	closed	74%	85%	90%

Under 70% (lighter = emptier)
 70–89%
 90% and up

! = over capacity. Capacity = smaller of district Cap Total and Cordon Clark. Receiving schools and splits as described in closure_scenarios.md.

One closure

- **Dewey**, split three ways, leaves every receiver at 74–78%, but its TWI strand needs a new home.
- **Orrington**, kept together, fills Willard to 90% and all 24 of its classrooms.
- **Lincolnwood** kept together doesn't fit:
 - Sent whole to Orrington, it would reach 117%, with 23 classes for 19 classrooms.
 - Sent whole to Willard instead, it lands right at the limit (101%, 25 classes for 24 classrooms).
 - Split between Orrington and Willard, it fits (81% and 79%), but every grade is divided between two schools.
 - STEP moves either way.
- **Oakton**, the fullest building today, splits three ways into Dawes, Washington and Dewey at 84–88%. Washington would use all 24 classrooms, and Oakton's TWI strand and ACC program both need new hosts.

- **Added: Dawes** splits three ways into Oakton, Washington and Dewey. Every receiver stays under capacity (Dewey 80%, Washington 85%, Oakton 90%), with classrooms to spare: 20 of 24 at Dewey, 21 of 25 at Oakton, 22 of 24 at Washington.
 - It displaces 280 students, the fewest of any south closure, and 14–42 would leave D65.
 - Dawes's TWI strand has to move. Washington already has two strands, so it would go to Dewey or Oakton.
 - Receivers are assumed from geography.

Two closures

- **Six pairs keep every receiver under capacity:** Washington, Oakton or **Dawes**, paired with Willard or Orrington. Even these reach 90–94% somewhere, and each moves at least one TWI strand.
- **Dawes + Orrington** and **Dawes + Willard** displace the fewest students (26–82 would leave D65). Their fullest receiver is Oakton at 90% or Lincolnwood at 92%.
- **Dawes + Lincolnwood** overfills Orrington (117%), like every pair that sends Lincolnwood there.
- **Every pair with Dewey or Lincolnwood overfills Orrington or Willard**, up to 136%.
- **Programs make relocation costly:** TWI at Dewey, Washington, Oakton and Dawes, ACC at Oakton and STEP at Lincolnwood.
- **Each pair could lose 26–101 students from the district.**

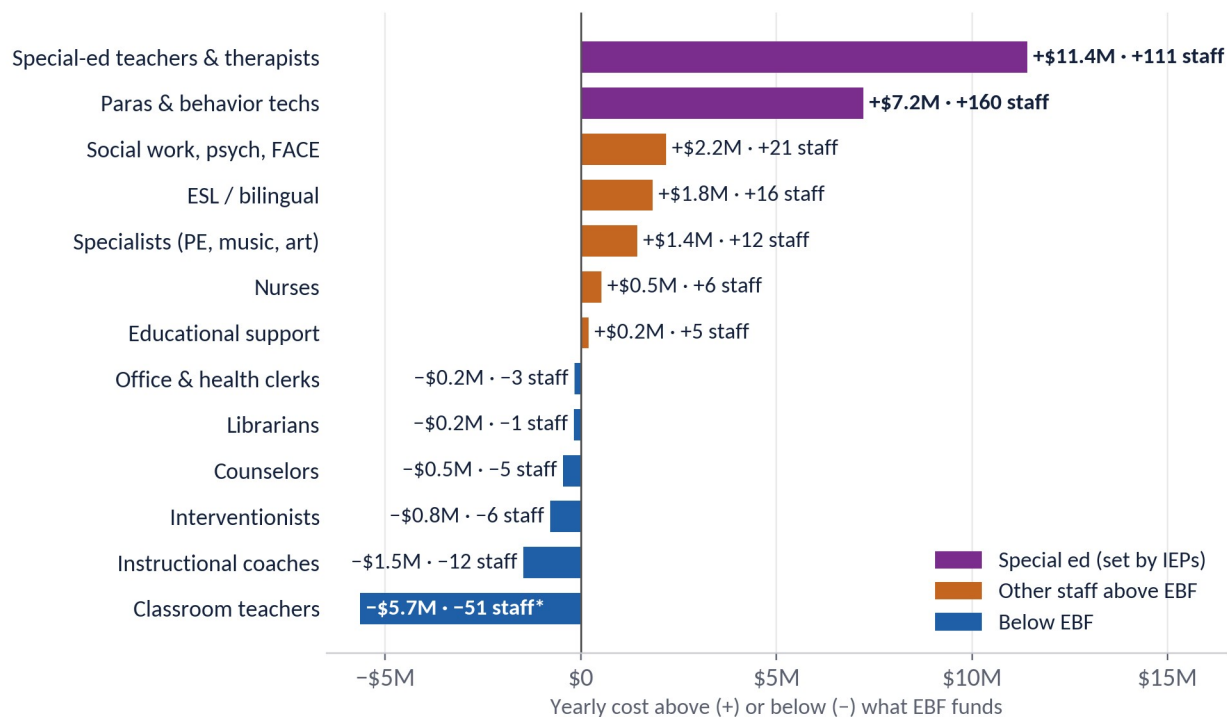
Method and sources:

- Projection: grades roll forward one year; incoming K = this year's K.
- Capacity: the smaller of the district's Cap Total and Cordogan Clark.
- Receiving schools: Washington's follow the district's SDRP 3D table. Willard's, Oakton's and Dawes's are assumed from geography.
- Full tables at 85%, 90% and 95% retention are in `projections/closure_scenarios.md`.

Estimates built with help from Claude (AI); please verify.

03 • State funding model (EBF): how K–5 staffing compares with Evidence-Based Funding

Illinois's Evidence-Based Funding formula sets out how many staff the State pays for. On paper, D65 has about 252 more K–5 staff than EBF funds, worth \$15.9M a year. Special education explains all of that difference.



- **+\$18.6M, special ed:** special-ed teachers, therapists and paras above EBF's ratio of 1 teacher and 1 aide per 141 students. Staffing follows IEPs and federal law, so this can't simply be cut to match.
- **+\$6.2M, other groups above EBF:**
 - Social workers and psychologists: \$2.2M
 - ESL teachers: \$1.8M
 - Specialists: \$1.4M
 - Nurses: \$0.5M
- **-\$8.9M, where we're below EBF:** classroom teachers, instructional coaches (6 vs. 18), interventionists and counselors.

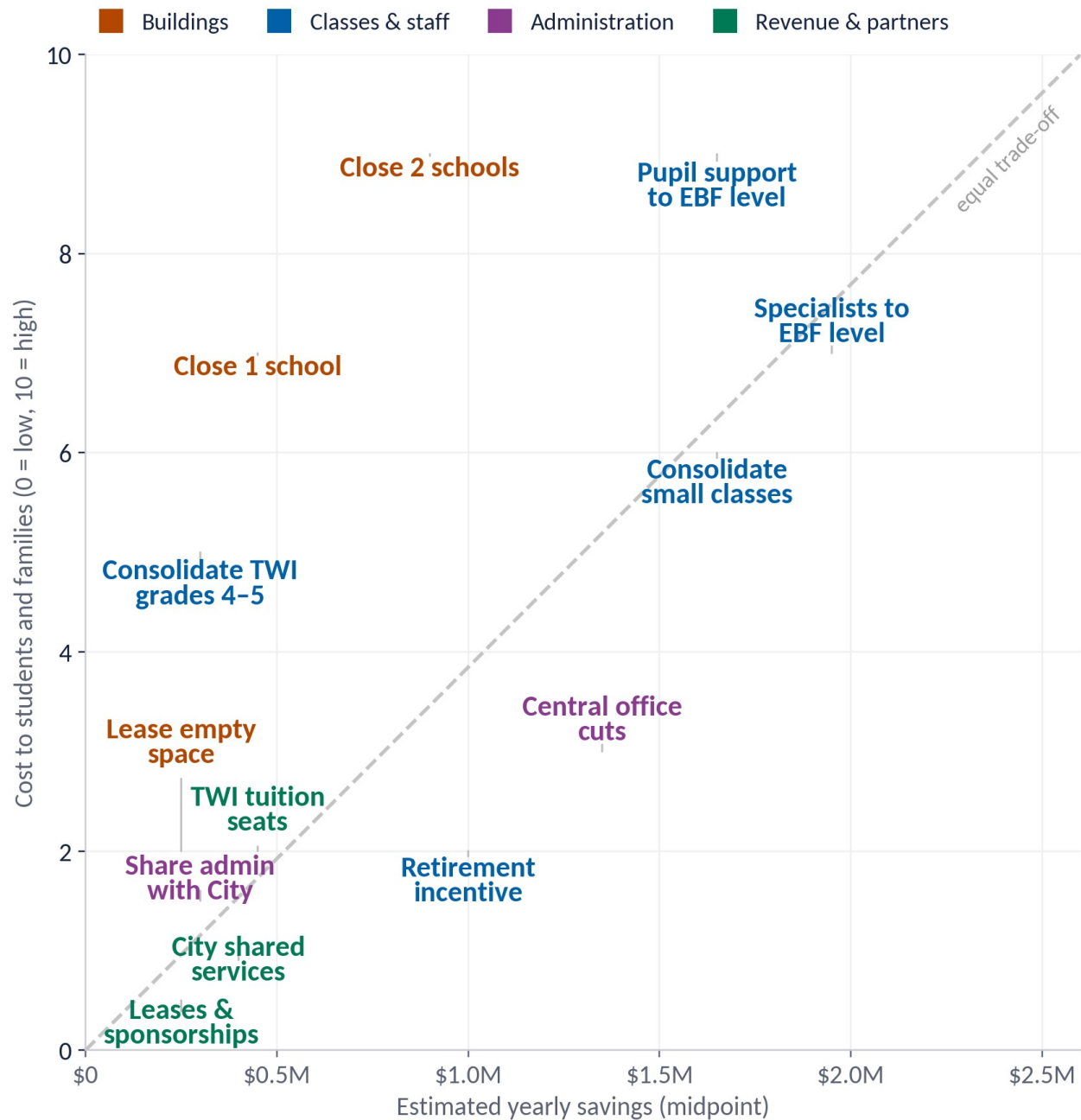
K–5 staffing	1 school	9 schools	10 schools	11 (today)
Staff EBF funds	419	452	467	492
Staff we have (est.)	745	745	745	745
Yearly cost above EBF	\$24.4M	\$20.6M	\$18.8M	\$15.9M
Special ed and paras	\$18.6M	\$18.6M	\$18.6M	\$18.6M
Everything else	\$5.8M	\$1.9M	\$0.2M	-\$2.7M

Notes:

- EBF is a funding model, not a staffing rule.
- The classroom-teacher figure is an upper bound: split evenly over 11 buildings, every grade rounds up to 3 classes.
- Staff other than classroom teachers are estimated for K–5 at 64% of the district count. Some non-teaching pay is assumed.
- Ratios are from 105 ILCS 5/18-8.15.

04 • The options: what each option saves, and what it costs students

Plotting savings against harm puts the choices side by side. Options under the dashed line save more for less disruption to students and families.



- **Where the money is.** Consolidating small classes, bringing specialist and support staffing closer to EBF levels, and central-office cuts each save \$1–2.5M a year. One closure saves \$0.2–0.7M.
- **Small but low-harm.** Leasing empty space, TWI tuition seats, shared City services and sponsorships each bring in \$0.1–0.6M, with little effect on classrooms.
- **About the scores.** The cost-to-students scores are a first draft for discussion. The savings ranges are rough; items marked "estimate" below are illustrative.

Option	Yearly savings	How we estimated it
Close 1 school	\$0.2–0.7M	Building-use analysis: building savings

Option	Yearly savings	How we estimated it
		minus added busing (net per closure)
Close 2 schools	\$0.4–1.4M	Two times the per-closure net; relocation and renovation costs not included
Lease or share empty space	\$0.1–0.4M	Estimate: preschool or community partner leases in underused wings
Consolidate small classes	\$1.1–2.2M	10–20 fewer sections × ~\$111K average teacher pay (EBF analysis)
Consolidate TWI strands in grades 4–5	\$0.2–0.4M	2–4 fewer upper-grade TWI sections × ~\$111K
Specialist teachers to EBF level	\$1.4–2.5M	12–22 FTE above EBF × ~\$115K (EBF Table 3)
Pupil support to EBF level	\$1.1–2.2M	Half to all of the 21 social work/psych/FACE FTE above EBF × ~\$103K
Voluntary retirement incentive	\$0.5–1.5M	Estimate: 25–40 retirements replaced at lower step pay net of incentive
Central office admin cuts	\$0.9–1.8M	Estimate: 5–10 central office positions × ~\$180K total comp
Share admin services with City	\$0.1–0.5M	Estimate: shared office space and personnel (creative ideas menu)
TWI tuition seats	\$0.3–0.6M	Estimate: 20–40 tuition students × ~\$15K
City shared services	\$0.2–0.6M	Estimate: crossing guards, maintenance, purchasing (creative ideas menu)
Cell tower, solar and sponsorship revenue	\$0.1–0.4M	Estimate: cell tower, solar panel and facility sponsorship revenue (creative ideas menu)

Added note: closure savings above are operating only. If a closed building is sold or leased long-term, it also avoids \$1.2–3.1M a year in facility-plan capital needs in 2027–31 (see section 01).

05 • Communicating the plan: what families should hear

Families will judge any plan by what happens in their child's classroom. The plan should say plainly what it protects, what changes, and how the district will show it's working.

Our priorities: what comes first

- Class sizes in a set range for every grade at every school
- Children stay with their classmates and teachers wherever possible
- Programs families chose stay whole: TWI, ACC, STEP
- Every IEP is fully served, through any change
- Savings reinvested where EBF says we're short: coaching and intervention

What families get: what changes for them

- Predictable class sizes, published for each school and grade
- No building moves next school year
- More reading and math intervention as savings are reinvested
- A clear budget: what was cut, what it saved, where it went

Educational outcomes: how we'll know it's working

- Class size by school and grade, every fall
- Reading and math growth by school and student group
- Attendance and chronic absence
- Special-ed service minutes delivered vs. IEPs
- Families staying in D65: transfers in, out and to private schools

Scorecard to publish each term

Measure	What would trigger a second look	Reported
Class size	Any grade above the agreed range, or below it two years running	Each fall
Reading and math growth	A school or student group falling behind its prior year	Winter, spring
Attendance	Chronic absence rising at a school affected by a change	Each term
Special-ed services	Any gap between minutes in IEPs and minutes delivered	Each term
Enrollment and transfers	Kindergarten or transfers off projection by more than 5%	Fall, spring
Savings	Actual savings below the plan, or one-time costs above it	Each budget cycle

Key messages

"We're protecting what happens in the classroom first: class sizes, programs, and every child's services."

"We'll make the biggest savings where they do the least harm, and we'll show our work."

The class-size range and trigger thresholds are for the district and community to set; the ones here are starting points for discussion.

Recap: the whole brief on one page

1–3.5%	of the 0.2–0.7M a year)
\$18.6M	special-ed staffing above EBF's ratio: the whole gap, set by IEPs
8 of 19	closure scenarios push a receiving school over capacity (was 7 of 15 before Dawes was added)
\$1,940	per student to run Willard today, the costliest building; \$1,500 at Walker
\$3,700–7,700	<i>Added:</i> facility-plan capital need per student a year (2027–31, scenario-average enrollment), 2.6–5 times operating cost; highest at Washington and Willard

Takeaways

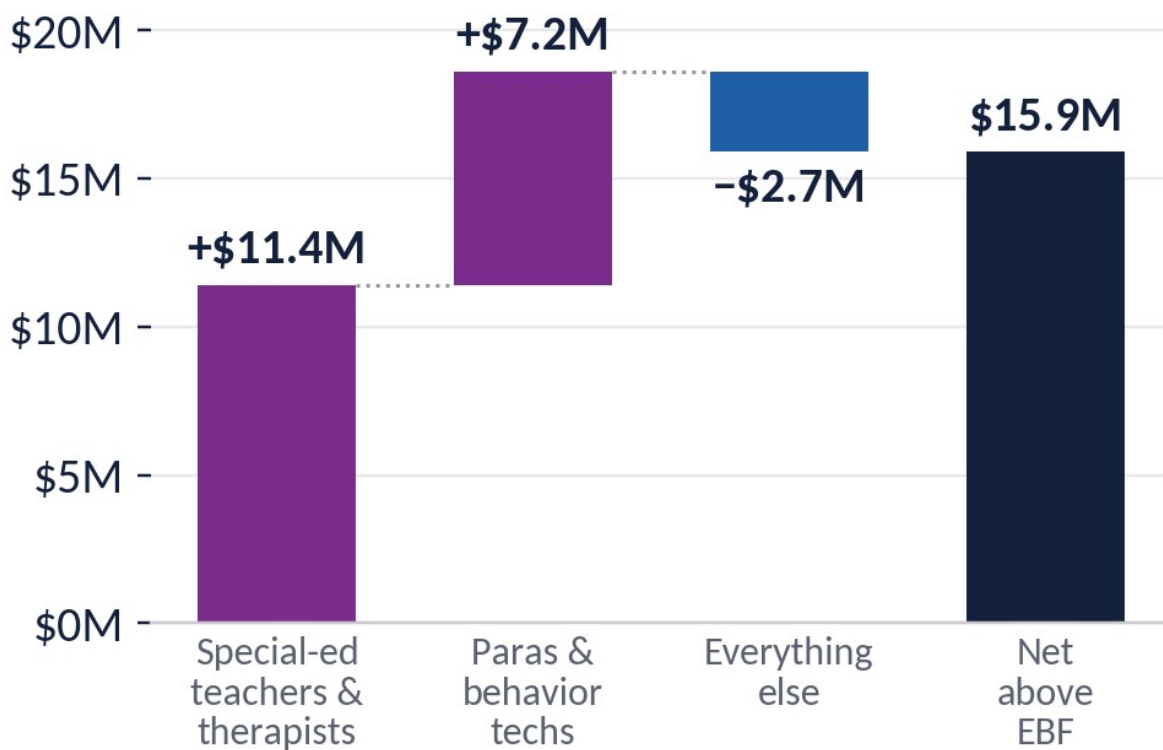
1. **Class size depends on school and grade:** grade averages run from 13 to 26 students, and they don't track how full a building is ($r = -0.14$). (*Class size section*)
2. **Emptier buildings cost more per student:** \$1,500–1,950 today. Receivers get cheaper per student, but the district saves only the closed building's costs. *Including 2027–31 facility-plan capital needs, Washington and Willard cost the most per student at scenario-average enrollment (about \$9,200 a year); Lincoln and Orrington the least (about \$5,100–5,200). (Section 01)*

3. **Where students go decides if a closure fits.** Every scenario that overfills sends students into Orrington or Willard; TWI, STEP and ACC moves are costly. *A Dawes closure fits, split among Oakton, Washington and Dewey. (Section 02)*
4. **Special ed explains the whole EBF gap.** Without it we're \$2.7M below the model, and short on coaches and interventionists. *(Section 03)*
5. **Staffing and class structure save more:** \$1–2.5M each, against \$0.2–0.7M per closure. *(Section 04)*
6. **Tell families what's protected, what they get, and publish a scorecard each term.** *(Section 05)*

What we're asking: what to convey in the plan

1. Itemized savings from the Kingsley and Bessie Rhodes closures, net of opening Foster.
2. The full cost of closing and relocating a school, including TWI, STEP and ACC moves.
3. Which positions would be cut, by category, and what each saves.
4. Class counts and class sizes by grade, before and after, not just utilization.
5. How the plan improves outcomes for students, not only this year's budget.

Decide by outcomes, learn from the data, and treat engaged families as an asset. We need to work with the buildings and the district we have.



Appendix (added): classroom counts vs. the Facility Master Plan

The handout's classroom counts come from the Cordogan Clark floor plans (2022; Foster uses Cordogan teaching stations). The District's March 2026 [Facility Master Plan](#) (Studio GC) has a room-by-room schedule for every building, surveyed October 2025 – January 2026. We counted rooms named "CLASSROOM" in its **Core Curriculum department** and compared.

School	Handout (Cordogan)	Facility plan "CLASSROOM"	Other facility-plan rooms that could serve as homeroom s	Difference	Sections today (district list, Oct 1, 2026)	Classes needed 2027–28, no closures	Spare rooms 2027–28: handout / facility plan
Dawes	20	21	SPED/OT room 16 (1,104 SF)	+1	16	13	7 / 8
Dewey	24	26	—	+2	18	15	9 / 11
Foster	24*	not in plan	—	—	20	16	8 / —
Lincoln	28	30	—	+2	18	18	10 / 12
Lincolnwood	19	18	2 "Learning Studio" rooms (812 and 825 SF)	–1	16	14	5 / 4
Oakton	25	21 shown†	—	–1 to –4	23	18	7 / 3–6
Orrington	19	17	"Classroom/ Sensory Rm" 106 (988 SF), "Sensory Rm" 113 (669 SF)	–2	13	13	6 / 4
Walker	18	19	—	+1	15	15	3 / 4
Washington	24	27	—	+3	22	18	6 / 9
Willard	24	23	none (one 256 SF "classroom" is filed as small-group space)	–1	13	13	11 / 10
King Arts	27	30	—	+3	14	—	—
Kingsley (closing)	20	22 (one is 311 SF)	—	+2	—	—	—

* Foster has no floor-plan count and isn't in the facility plan. † Oakton's schedule is cut off in the PDF: 24 Core Curriculum rooms are listed in the subtotal but only 21 rows are visible.

"Sections today" is the district's FY27 K–5 section list, received by email October 1, 2026 (TWI and ACC included). "Classes needed" is each grade's projected 2027–28 students ÷ 24, rounded up (no TWI or special-ed sections), the same rule as the closure scenarios, so it runs below today's sections at schools with TWI or ACC.

What it changes in the closure scenarios

The facility plan and the handout agree within 1–3 rooms at most schools. The differences land on the schools that matter most for the north-side scenarios:

- **Willard has 23 classrooms in the facility plan, not 24.**
 - Every scenario that sends Orrington whole to Willard needs 24 classes there, so it goes from "full" to **one classroom short**. That covers Close Orrington, and Washington, Oakton or Dawes + Orrington.
 - Lincolnwood → Willard (25 classes) becomes two short. Dewey + Orrington (26 classes) becomes three short.
- **Lincolnwood (18) and Orrington (17) are tighter.**

- The three "+ Willard" pairs (Washington, Oakton or Dawes + Willard) need 19 classes at each. They fit only if Lincolnwood's two learning studios and Orrington's two sensory rooms are used as homerooms.
- Close Dewey and the Lincolnwood split (3b) need exactly 17 at Orrington: full, with the sensory rooms as the only slack.
- **Washington has 27, not 24.** Closing Oakton (alone or in a pair) needs 24 classes at Washington, so it has 3 spare rooms instead of none.
- **Oakton already uses 23 sections this fall**, more than the 21 classrooms visible in the facility plan. That fits the plan's own count of 24 Core Curriculum rooms (3 rows are cut off in the PDF) and leaves little room.
- **Oakton is tighter than the handout shows.** Close Dawes and the Washington pairs need 21 classes there, against the 21 visible rooms (about 24 including the rows cut off in the PDF).

Bottom line. On capacity (seats), the six "fits" pairs still fit. On classrooms, using the facility plan's counts:

- None of the six has a spare room at every receiver.
- The three "+ Orrington" pairs are one room short at Willard.
- The three "+ Willard" pairs work only by converting specialized rooms.

Before relying on either count, the district should confirm homeroom counts building by building. The two sources were surveyed three years apart and may label the same rooms differently.

Scenario-by-scenario detail:

facility_master_plan_2026/fmp_vs_handout_classrooms_by_scenario.csv. Facility-plan room data: facility_master_plan_2026/fmp_rooms.csv.

Built with help from Claude (AI); please verify.